

xAI / SpaceXAI Partner Sync -- TOLA

Meeting Prep -- One-Pager Prepared by Chase (Jarvis) | 2026-06-24 | Session 59a96f87

Meeting Details

Date	Tuesday, June 24, 2026
Time	This afternoon (exact time TBC -- M365 connector offline at prep time)
Location	Teams / Virtual
Format	Partnership development sync -- follow-up to June 22 intro call
Partner Host	Cole Estrate, Enterprise Sales, xAI / SpaceXAI (cestrate@x.ai)
Partner CC	TBD -- partner to confirm additional attendees

Improving Attendees & Roles

Name	Title	Covering
David O'Hara	Regional Director, Dallas + South Texas	Partnership framing, account overlap, co-sell path, event collaboration
Ehren Seim (<i>if joining</i>)	Partner Team Lead, Improving	Formal partner program discussion, NDA status, co-sell program mechanics

Improving Presence & Resources -- TOLA

Improving maintains offices and delivery teams across the xAI TOLA territory available for joint events, workshops, and co-working:

Location	Office	Available For
Dallas, TX	Improving HQ -- Dallas (original office, est. 2007)	Executive AI workshops, client events, lunch & learns, community events, co-working
Houston, TX	Improving Houston	Client events, workshops, co-working
Austin, TX	Improving Austin	Workshops, lunch & learns, co-working

We're happy to host xAI partner events, joint workshops, Grok demos, or client meetings at any of our Texas locations. Dallas alone has 21 Fortune 500 companies in-market.

Priority Accounts

Note: CRM connector unavailable at prep time. Account mapping below is drawn from MISSION_CONTROL active pursuits + previous meeting context. Full account-by-account mapping is the planned next step (post-NDA, account mapping session). This table is the starting point for that conversation.

Group 1: Active Relationships (Joint Opportunity)

Accounts where Improving has existing engagement and Grok/xAI could accelerate value or be layered in:

Account	Improving Seller	xAI Rep	Notes
AT&T	Derek Nwamadi	TBD -- Cole to fill	Active pursuit, Dallas. Large enterprise AI opportunity -- AT&T's scale makes Grok's 30-40% cost advantage highly relevant for any production AI deployment.
Texas Instruments	Alexander Powell	TBD -- Cole to fill	Active pursuit, Dallas. R&D-heavy org; Grok Build / coding agent angle could be compelling alongside Improving's engineering delivery.
CBRE	Rod Patane	TBD -- Cole to fill	Active pursuit, Dallas. Real estate tech + AI adoption is an emerging vertical. Grok for data analysis + Improving's adoption program = strong combined pitch.
Tenet Healthcare	Mark Miesner	TBD -- Cole to fill	Active pursuit, Dallas. Healthcare AI is high-stakes; Grok's enterprise security positioning and cost efficiency matter here.
Builders FirstSource	Diana Stevens	TBD -- Cole to fill	Active pursuit, Dallas. Industrial/manufacturing vertical -- one of Cole's stated priority verticals in TOLA. High overlap potential.
Marriott	Chris Rogan	TBD -- Cole to fill	Active pursuit, Houston. Hospitality AI use cases (operations, guest experience); Improving + Grok adoption play.
Constellation Energy	TBD -- David to assign	TBD -- Cole to fill	Active pursuit, Houston. Energy sector -- oil/gas/energy is Cole's top TOLA vertical. Strong vertical alignment.
Kirby Corp	TBD -- David to assign	TBD -- Cole to fill	Houston. Marine transportation / energy logistics. Industrial vertical alignment with xAI TOLA focus.

Group 2: Target Accounts (Joint Pursuit)

Accounts Improving is pursuing where xAI could open doors or add credibility:

Account	Improving Seller	xAI Rep	Notes
Expedia	TBD (Houston)	TBD -- Cole to fill	Tech-forward company; Grok API integration + Improving delivery could be compelling. Cole's intro to xAI's Expedia relationship (if any) would help.
Masimo	TBD (Houston)	TBD -- Cole to fill	Medical devices / healthcare tech. If Cole has a relationship here, joint intro valuable.
[Fortune 500 Dallas accounts not yet in active pursuit]	TBD	TBD -- Cole to fill	Dallas has 21 F500 companies. Improving has touched ~17. Cole covers all of them. This is the discovery conversation.

Group 3: xAI Accounts (Improving Can Help)

Accounts where xAI has Grok deployed but adoption is low -- Improving's Deep Learning Program (70-85% adoption vs. industry average 25-35%) is the value-add:

Account	Improving Seller	xAI Rep	Notes
TBD -- Cole to fill	TBD	Cole Estrate	<i>Cole: which of your current Grok accounts are stuck at 25-35% utilization? These are our highest-value targets. Improving's 12-week embedded program is the solution.</i>
TBD -- Cole to fill	TBD	Cole Estrate	
TBD -- Cole to fill	TBD	Cole Estrate	

Cole: the financial services accounts (major banks) you mentioned from IPO-era deals are especially interesting here. If Grok is deployed but adoption is stalled, we can move the needle. What's your best example of a customer who bought but hasn't activated?

Upcoming Events

Events where joint presence, co-sponsorship, or client invitations could create value. **xAI team: please add your upcoming events.**

Improving Events

Event	Date	Location	Opportunity for xAI
Executive AI Workshop (DRC)	May 21, 2026 (<i>past -- reference for format</i>)	Dallas	Template for joint workshop format. Grok could be featured AI partner in future editions.
Community Events (ongoing)	Rolling	Dallas / Houston / Austin	Movie nights, workshops, networking -- Cole mentioned the Supergirl movie night format. xAI can get joint events approved quickly. Next one: David to confirm date.
[<i>Next Executive AI Workshop</i>]	TBD -- scheduling	Dallas	Co-present with Cole on Grok enterprise case studies. Joint invite list = combined F500 reach.

xAI / SpaceXAI Events

Event	Date	Location	Opportunity for Improving
TBD -- Cole to fill			
[<i>Tesla event model -- data + AI format</i>]	TBD	Dallas area	Cole referenced previous Tesla co-hosted event with xAI speakers. Improving could co-host or send speakers.

Industry Events (Both Attending)

Event	Date	Location	Joint Plans
Databricks 2026 Data + AI Summit	June 18, 2026 (<i>just occurred</i>)	Virtual/SF	Grok now natively on Databricks Agent Bricks -- Improving has data engineering delivery capability. Joint solution pitch opportunity at next edition.
[<i>Energy/O&G conference -- TBD</i>]	TBD	Houston / Dallas	Oil and gas is Cole's top TOLA vertical and a major Improving vertical. Find the right conference to co-present or co-sponsor.

xAI / Grok News & Updates

Relevant developments since the June 22 intro call:

- **Grok 4.3 on Amazon Bedrock (GA):** Grok is now the third independent lab model on Bedrock alongside Anthropic and Claude. Priced at \$1.25 input / \$2.50 output per million tokens -- the cheapest US-lab frontier reasoning model on the platform. 1M token context window. This reinforces Cole's cost-advantage pitch. ([source](#))
- **Grok on Databricks Agent Bricks (June 18):** Announced at the 2026 Data + AI Summit. Grok now connects directly to Lakehouse-stored enterprise data for agent reasoning. Improving's data engineering practice is a natural delivery layer here. ([source](#))
- **Grok for Microsoft Word (M365 add-in):** Free add-in that integrates Grok into Word with SharePoint, email, and Google Drive connectors. Improving is a Microsoft managed partner -- this is a relevant integration to discuss with mutual Microsoft-stack clients. ([source](#))
- **No formal xAI consulting partner program published as of June 2026.** Cole's engagement is a direct relationship -- which may mean more flexibility on deal structure, but also less infrastructure (no MDF program, no formal co-sell terms yet). This is worth clarifying today.

Discussion Topics

Status update (June 24, pre-meeting): NDA signed ☐ Ehren Seim intro sent ☐ account mapping session scheduled ☐ — that's this meeting. Walk in with all three action items closed. The only open item is the community event invite.

1. **This IS the account mapping session.** Walk in with the Group 1 and Group 2 tables above and ask Cole to fill in his side — which accounts does he cover, who's his rep, and where is Grok already deployed? The table is the artifact. Leave today with a populated doc.
2. **Ehren Seim — what's the next step?** The intro has been sent. Has Cole connected with Ehren yet? What does the formal partner program path look like from xAI's side?
3. **Grok on Databricks -- does this change the co-sell pitch?** Databricks integration just launched June 18. Improving has data engineering delivery. Is there a joint solution here (Grok on Databricks + Improving delivery) that Cole's enterprise accounts would respond to?
4. **The adoption gap -- who's Cole's best example?** Improving's core value prop is getting Grok utilization from 25-35% to 70-85%. Ask Cole: "Which of your current accounts has the worst adoption problem?" That's the first co-sell target.
5. **xAI's formal partner program -- does it exist?** Web research shows no published co-sell program with formal terms as of today. What's the path to formalizing the relationship? Are there partner tiers, MDF, co-sell registration?
6. **Joint event -- can we put a date on it?** Cole said he can get fast xAI approvals for joint events. Let's put a specific event on the calendar: an Executive AI Workshop co-hosted with xAI featuring Grok, hosted at Improving Dallas. Who does Cole need approval from, and what's the lead time?
7. **What verticals is Cole seeing the most Grok traction in right now?** Oil and gas, industrial manufacturing, and financial services were his top three on June 22. Has anything shifted? This drives which of Improving's active accounts to prioritize in the mapping session.

Action Items from Previous Meeting (June 22, 2026)

#	Owner	Action	Status	Notes
1	David	Introduce Ehren Seim to Cole	☐ Done	Intro sent via email.
2	David	Sign NDA with Cole Estrate / xAI	☐ Done	NDA confirmed signed (visible in sent email).
3	David + Cole	Schedule account mapping session (post-NDA)	☐ Done — happening today	Account mapping is scheduled for this afternoon — this meeting IS that session.
4	David	Invite Cole to a future Improving community event	Open	No specific event named yet. Propose a date today.

Background & Relationship History

How it started: Cole Estrate (xAI Enterprise Sales, TOLA territory) reached out to David via a Tesla co-hosted AI event that Improving attended. Cole's initial network reach resulted in a contact who said "go talk to David." Cole organized the first call on June 22, 2026.

June 22 Intro Call (32 min): First structured conversation. David walked Cole through Improving's model (22 offices, 2,000 people, all acquired, conscious capitalism culture, largest Scrum.org certifier globally). Cole positioned Grok as enterprise-first, 30-40% cheaper than OpenAI/Anthropic, already deployed in all major US banks, with oil/gas, industrial manufacturing, and financial services as top TOLA verticals. Both aligned on the "adoption gap" problem -- organizations buy AI licenses, get 25-35% utilization, don't know why ROI hasn't shown up. Improving's Deep Learning Program (12-week embedded engineer + executive coach) moves adoption to 70-85%. This is the co-sell thesis.

Three agreed next steps from June 22: NDA execution, Ehren Seim intro, account mapping session.

Devlin's take (June 23 internal call): Devlin's reaction to the xAI partnership initiation was measured -- acknowledged Grok's financial services penetration was largely forced through IPO leverage ("Elon bent everybody over"), and that the commodity model layer isn't where durable advantage lives. David's framing: the operating layer above the model is Improving's moat. That's still the right position. Worth keeping in mind if the conversation ever gets into competitive AI model comparisons -- Improving doesn't bet on models, we bet on adoption.

Internal Notes (Chase -- Not for Sharing)

The real prize here: This isn't just a referral relationship. If Improving becomes xAI's preferred adoption delivery partner in TOLA, we get warm intros to every Grok enterprise account in Texas, Oklahoma, Louisiana, and Arkansas. Cole has one other TOLA rep (out of Austin). Combined they're covering 123 Fortune 1000s. Improving's Deep Learning Program is the only credible answer to the utilization problem. Don't undersell this.

Watch the Anthropic tension: Improving is an emerging Anthropic managed partner. Grok competes directly with Claude. Don't bring this up proactively, but don't pretend it doesn't exist if Cole asks. The answer is: Improving is model-agnostic at the delivery layer -- we help clients succeed with whatever AI platform they've selected. That's true and it's defensible.

No formal xAI partner program yet. This cuts both ways: less infrastructure to plug into, but also an opportunity to help define the program. Ask Cole what formalizing the partnership looks like on xAI's side.

The Cursor angle: Cursor acquisition by xAI is publicly rumored but unsigned as of June 22. Grok Build is the coding agent product. If this closes, it could significantly change the Grok Build / developer tooling story. Keep an ear out.

Accelerate to the account mapping session. That's the milestone that makes this partnership concrete. Everything else -- joint events, Ehren intro, formal program -- is secondary to getting names and accounts on a shared doc. Today's job is to get a specific date for that session.

Document prepared by Chase (Jarvis IES) | Partner: xAI / SpaceXAI | Contact: Cole Estrate (cestrate@x.ai) | Previous prep: First structured prep doc (June 22 was intro call, no prior prep doc) | M365 calendar connector offline at prep time -- meeting time not confirmed from calendar, pull from invite directly.